considerable time in the Palestinian-controlled parts of the West Bank, and I make regular visits to Gaza.

I do not claim to know everything about this place, with its endless complexity and deep divides; no one does. Nor do I claim to be an unbiased observer; no one is. But this book is, I hope, a good-faith effort to document the events of three tumultuous years, viewed from all sides, and to use that as a prism through which to consider the future.

My own politics are very much on the left side of the spectrum. I do not believe in the two-state solution, either on practical grounds or ideological ones. And yet some of the most enlightening conversations I've had about the "peace process" have been with right-wing settlers, those who also believe that partitioning the land is impossible. We disagree on the details, of course, but I find their overall views to be more realistic and clear-eyed than those of the graying Labor "peace camp" or the lifelong negotiators in Jerusalem, Ramallah and Washington.

The conclusions and insights presented here, if I may call them that, are drawn from a wide range of sources. Any mistakes, of course, are mine alone.